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# Co-Wives: Easing Rivalry

*Step out of the war, protect your peace*

4 psychology approaches · tips — by EvaTalk

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## TO BEGIN

# Step out of the war, protect your peace

Rivalry between co-wives isn't inevitable: it's often manufactured by the situation itself — competing for time, attention, resources. The other woman isn't necessarily your enemy.

This guide helps you step out of a war you didn't choose, and protect your inner peace.

## YOUR INTENTION

With which co-wife is the tension strongest, and over what? \_\_\_\_\_

## Rivalry is built by the system

When several women depend on the same time and resources, competition sets in almost mechanically. It's not a character flaw: the situation pushes toward rivalry.

Understanding this lets you stop seeing the other as the ultimate enemy, and aim for your peace rather than a victory.

### Example

*Aminata hated her co-wife — until she realized they were both fighting over the scraps of one system, not enemies at heart.*

### See the system

Note what you're truly competing over (time, money, attention...).

### Change the goal

Write: 'My goal isn't to win against her, but to protect my peace.'

*Takeaway — Rivalry is often built by the situation — not by the other woman.*

## The thoughts that feed rivalry

'She's better than me', 'she's stealing my place', 'I must outdo her': these thoughts lock you into an exhausting, endless comparison.

Spotting and softening them defuses much of the inner war.

### Example

*'She wins, I lose' obsessed Fatou. Stepping out of that match logic, she found air and sleep again.*

### Spot the comparison

Note a rivalry thought · a version that doesn't pit you in competition.

### Leave the match

Write: 'My worth isn't played out against hers.'

*Takeaway — Your worth isn't played out against another woman's.*

## Protect your peace

You don't have to win a war you didn't declare. You can choose to protect your calm, energy and dignity, instead of draining them in rivalry.

Refusing the constant fight is already reclaiming power over your life.

### Example

*By no longer watching her co-wife, Nia recovered huge energy for what truly mattered to her.*

### My peace first

What does rivalry cost you (energy, sleep, mood)?

### Reclaim my energy

Something to devote the energy you put into rivalry to: \_\_\_\_\_

*Takeaway — You don't have to win a war you didn't choose.*

## Coexist, even ally

In practice, you can set limits, aim for minimal respect, and sometimes even turn rivalry into alliance — because the husband often plays the wives against each other (triangulation).

Protecting yourself from this game means refusing to be a pawn in a strategy that doesn't serve you.

### Example

*Rather than tear each other apart, two co-wives settled on simple rules — and daily life calmed down.*

### Spot triangulation

Are you sometimes turned against the other by the husband? How to refuse this game?

### A minimal frame

A rule of respect or coexistence to propose: \_\_\_\_\_

*Takeaway — Refuse to be a pawn: your peace is worth more than rivalry.*

## Key takeaways

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- Rivalry is often built by the situation, not the other woman.
- Your worth isn't played out against a co-wife's.
- Leave the match logic that drains you.
- Protect your peace, energy and dignity.
- Beware triangulation (being turned against the other).
- Set a frame of respect; an alliance is sometimes possible.

## Your turn

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### The rivalry

| Over what | The thought feeding it |
|-----------|------------------------|
|           |                        |
|           |                        |
|           |                        |
|           |                        |

### My peace

| What it costs me | My frame / reinvested energy |
|------------------|------------------------------|
|                  |                              |
|                  |                              |
|                  |                              |
|                  |                              |



YOUR JOURNEY

## Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1**

See how the system builds rivalry.

**Week 2**

Leave comparison behind.

**Week 3**

Protect my peace and energy.

**Week 4**

Set a frame, refuse triangulation.

## YOUR PLAN

# Your action plan

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My new goal (instead of winning):

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What I reinvest my energy in:

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The frame of respect I propose:

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*Your peace is worth more than any rivalry.*

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